

Backend Introduction

A Spring Boot backend application for a RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation) based intelligent Q&A system. This system enables users to upload documents and engage in intelligent conversations based on the document content using OpenAI's GPT models and vector embeddings.

System demo: <http://downey.top/login>

Table of Contents

- [Technology Stack](#)
- [System Architecture & Features](#)
- [Local Development](#)
- [Docker Deployment](#)

Technology Stack

Core Framework

- **Java 17** - Programming language
- **Spring Boot 3.3.3** - Application framework
- **Spring Security** - Authentication and authorization
- **MyBatis 3.0.4** - ORM framework (SSM architecture)

Database

- **MySQL 8.4.0** - Relational database
- **Flyway** - Database migration tool

AI & ML

- **LangChain4j 0.33.0** - Java framework for LLM applications
- **OpenAI API** - GPT-4o-mini for chat, text-embedding-3-small for embeddings
- **InMemoryEmbeddingStore** - Vector storage for document embeddings

Security

- **JWT (jjwt 0.11.5)** - Token-based authentication

Document Processing

- **Apache PDFBox** - PDF document parsing
- **Apache POI 5.2.5 & 4.1.2** - Word document parsing (.doc, .docx)

Build Tools

- **Maven** - Dependency management and build tool

System Architecture & Features

Architecture Overview

The system follows a layered architecture:

```
Controller Layer (REST API)
  ↓
Service Layer (Business Logic)
  ↓
Mapper Layer (Data Access)
  ↓
Database (MySQL)
```

Core Features

1. User Authentication & Authorization

- User registration with role-based access (Admin/User)
- JWT token-based authentication
- Password encryption using BCrypt
- Token expiration and refresh handling

2. Document Management

- **Multi-format Support:** PDF, TXT, MD, HTML, DOC, DOCX
- **Document Parsing:** Automatic text extraction from various formats
- **Vector Indexing:** Documents are split into chunks and converted to embeddings
- **Document Storage:** File upload and metadata management
- **Index Rebuilding:** Automatic re-indexing on application startup

3. RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation) System

- **Semantic Search:** Vector similarity search using OpenAI embeddings
- **Context Retrieval:** Top-K retrieval (K=4) of relevant document chunks
- **Intelligent Q&A:** GPT-4o-mini generates answers based on retrieved context
- **Reference Tracking:** Tracks and displays source documents for each answer
- **Context Awareness:** Maintains conversation history (last 10 messages)

4. Chat System

- **Multi-session Management:** Users can create multiple chat sessions
- **Message History:** Persistent storage of chat messages
- **Streaming Response:** Server-Sent Events (SSE) for real-time token streaming
- **Non-streaming Support:** Traditional request-response mode

API Endpoints

Authentication

- `POST /api/auth/register` - User registration
- `POST /api/auth/login` - User login

Document Management (Admin only)

- `POST /api/document/upload` - Upload document
- `GET /api/document/list` - List all documents
- `GET /api/document/{id}/preview` - Preview document
- `DELETE /api/document/{id}` - Delete document

Chat

- `POST /api/chat/create` - Create new chat session
- `GET /api/chat/list` - List user's chat sessions
- `GET /api/chat/{chatId}/history` - Get chat history
- `POST /api/chat/{chatId}/send` - Send message (non-streaming)
- `POST /api/chat/{chatId}/stream` - Send message (streaming, SSE)

Local Development

Prerequisites

- Java 17 or higher
- Maven 3.6+
- MySQL 8.0+
- OpenAI API Key

Setup Steps

1. Clone the repository

```
git clone <repository-url>
cd capstone
```

2. Configure MySQL Database

Create a MySQL database:

```
CREATE DATABASE rag_chat CHARACTER SET utf8mb4 COLLATE
utf8mb4_unicode_ci;
```

Update database credentials in `src/main/resources/application.yml` :

```
spring:
  datasource:
    url: jdbc:mysql://localhost:3306/rag_chat?
    useSSL=false&allowPublicKeyRetrieval=true&serverTimezone=Asia/Shanghai&
    username: root
    password: your_password
```

3. Set Environment Variables

Set your OpenAI API key:

```
export OPENAI_API_KEY=sk-your-api-key-here
```

Or configure it in `application.yml` :

```
app:
  openai:
    api-key: sk-your-api-key-here
```

4. Configure File Directories

Update paths in `application.yml`:

```
app:
  rag:
    index-dir: /path/to/vector-index
    upload-dir: /path/to/uploads
```

5. Build the Project

```
mvn clean install
```

6. Run the Application

```
mvn spring-boot:run
```

Or run the JAR file:

```
java -jar target/rag-chat-backend-0.0.1-SNAPSHOT.jar
```

7. Verify the Application

The application will start on `http://localhost:8080`

Check if the API is running:

```
curl http://localhost:8080/api/auth/login
```

Database Migration

Flyway will automatically run database migrations on application startup. Migration scripts are located in `src/main/resources/db/migration/`.

Development Notes

- The application uses Flyway for database schema management
- Document indexing happens automatically on upload
- Vector index is rebuilt on application startup via `RagBootstrap`
- Logs are configured in `logback-spring.xml` and output to `logs/app.log`

Docker Deployment

For Docker deployment instructions, please refer to [DEPLOYMENT_GUIDE.md](#).

The deployment guide includes:

- Docker and Docker Compose setup
- Environment configuration
- Service orchestration
- Data persistence
- Logging and monitoring
- Troubleshooting

Quick Docker Deployment

1. Create `.env` file with required environment variables
2. Build and start services:

```
docker compose up -d --build
```

3. Check service status:

```
docker compose ps
```

For detailed deployment steps, see [DEPLOYMENT_GUIDE.md](#).

Frontend Introduction

A modern React-based frontend application for the RAG Chat intelligent Q&A system. This single-page application provides a user-friendly interface for document management and AI-powered conversations based on uploaded documents.

System demo: <http://downey.top/login>

Table of Contents

- [Technology Stack](#)
- [System Architecture & Features](#)
- [Local Development](#)
- [Docker Deployment](#)

Technology Stack

Core Framework

- **React 19.1.1** - UI library
- **TypeScript 5.8.3** - Type-safe JavaScript
- **Vite 7.1.2** - Build tool and dev server

Routing & Navigation

- **React Router DOM 7.8.2** - Client-side routing

Styling

- **Tailwind CSS 3.4.17** - Utility-first CSS framework
- **@tailwindcss/typography 0.5.19** - Typography plugin for markdown content
- **PostCSS 8.5.6** - CSS processing
- **Autoprefixer 10.4.21** - CSS vendor prefixing

HTTP Client

- **Axios 1.12.0** - Promise-based HTTP client with interceptors

State Management

- **Jotai 2.14.0** - Atomic state management
- **React Hooks** - Built-in state management

Internationalization

- **i18next 25.6.0** - Internationalization framework
- **react-i18next 16.2.1** - React bindings for i18next
- **Supported Languages:** English, Chinese (Simplified)

UI Components & Utilities

- **react-markdown 10.1.0** - Markdown rendering for AI responses
- **Sonner 2.0.7** - Toast notification library
- **class-variance-authority 0.7.1** - Component variant management
- **clsx 2.1.1** - Utility for constructing className strings

Development Tools

- **ESLint 9.33.0** - Code linting
- **TypeScript ESLint 8.39.1** - TypeScript-specific linting rules
- **@vitejs/plugin-react 5.0.0** - Vite plugin for React

System Architecture & Features

Architecture Overview

The frontend follows a component-based architecture with clear separation of concerns:

```
Pages (Route Components)
  ↓
API Layer (Axios with interceptors)
  ↓
Backend API (REST + SSE)
```

Core Features

1. User Authentication

- **Login Page:** User authentication with JWT token storage
- **Register Page:** User registration with role selection (Admin/User)

- **Token Management:** Automatic token injection in API requests
- **Auto-redirect:** Unauthorized users are redirected to login
- **Session Persistence:** Token stored in localStorage

2. Chat Interface

- **Multi-session Management:** Create and manage multiple chat conversations
- **Real-time Streaming:** Server-Sent Events (SSE) for token-by-token response streaming
- **Message History:** Display conversation history with user and AI messages
- **Markdown Rendering:** Rich text formatting for AI responses
- **Auto-scroll:** Automatic scrolling to latest message
- **Optimistic Updates:** Immediate UI updates for better UX
- **Reference Display:** Show source documents for AI answers

3. Document Management (Admin Only)

- **Document Upload:** Multi-format file upload (PDF, TXT, MD, HTML, DOC, DOCX)
- **Document List:** Display all uploaded documents with metadata
- **Document Preview:** View document content in modal
- **Document Deletion:** Remove documents from knowledge base
- **Role-based Access:** Only admin users can access document management

4. Internationalization (i18n)

- **Language Switching:** Toggle between English and Chinese
- **Persistent Language:** Language preference saved in localStorage
- **Complete Translation:** All UI text translated for both languages

5. User Experience

- **Responsive Design:** Mobile and desktop optimized
- **Modern UI:** Clean, gradient-based design with Tailwind CSS
- **Toast Notifications:** User feedback for actions (success/error)
- **Loading States:** Visual feedback during async operations
- **Error Handling:** Graceful error handling with user-friendly messages

Page Structure

- **/login** - User login page
- **/register** - User registration page
- **/chat** - Main chat interface (default route)
- **/docs** - Document management page (admin only)

API Integration

The frontend communicates with the backend through:

- **REST API:** Standard HTTP requests for CRUD operations
- **SSE (Server-Sent Events):** Streaming chat responses
- **Axios Interceptors:** Automatic token injection and error handling

Key API modules:

- **AuthAPI** : Authentication endpoints
- **ChatAPI** : Chat and conversation management

- `DocsAPI` : Document upload and management

Local Development

Prerequisites

- **Node.js** 18+ (recommended: Node.js 20+)
- **npm** or **yarn** package manager
- Backend API running on `http://localhost:8080`

Setup Steps

1. Navigate to frontend directory

```
cd frontend
```

2. Install dependencies

```
npm install
```

Or using yarn:

```
yarn install
```

3. Start development server

```
npm run dev
```

The application will start on `http://localhost:5173` (default Vite port)

4. Access the application

Open your browser and navigate to:

```
http://localhost:5173
```

Development Scripts

- **npm run dev** - Start development server with hot module replacement (HMR)
- **npm run build** - Build production bundle to `dist/` directory
- **npm run preview** - Preview production build locally
- **npm run lint** - Run ESLint to check code quality

Configuration

API Proxy Configuration

The development server is configured to proxy API requests to the backend. This is configured in `vite.config.ts` :


```
server: {
  proxy: {
    '/api': {
      target: 'http://localhost:8080',
      changeOrigin: true,
    },
  },
}
```

If your backend runs on a different port, update the `target` in `vite.config.ts`.

Environment Variables

For production builds, you may need to configure the API base URL. Create a `.env` file:

```
VITE_API_BASE_URL=http://localhost:8080
```

Then update `src/lib/api.ts` to use the environment variable if needed.

Development Notes

- **Hot Module Replacement (HMR):** Changes are reflected instantly without full page reload
- **TypeScript:** Full type safety with TypeScript
- **ESLint:** Code quality checks on save (if configured in your IDE)
- **Browser DevTools:** React DevTools recommended for debugging

Building for Production

1. Build the application

```
npm run build
```

This creates an optimized production build in the `dist/` directory.

2. Preview the production build

```
npm run preview
```

3. Deploy the `dist/` directory

The `dist/` directory contains all static files needed for deployment. You can:

- Serve with any static file server (Nginx, Apache, etc.)
- Deploy to CDN or cloud storage
- Use with Docker (see Docker Deployment section)

Docker Deployment

For Docker deployment instructions, please refer to [DEPLOYMENT_GUIDE.md](#).

The deployment guide includes:

- Docker and Docker Compose setup
- Frontend build process in Docker
- Nginx configuration for serving static files
- API proxy configuration
- Production deployment steps

Quick Docker Deployment Overview

1. Build the frontend

```
npm run build
```

2. **Copy `dist/` contents** to the deployment directory
3. **Configure Nginx** to serve static files and proxy API requests
4. **Start services** with Docker Compose

For detailed deployment steps, see [DEPLOYMENT_GUIDE.md](#).

Nginx Configuration

The project includes an `nginx.conf` file for production deployment. Key features:

- Serves static files from `/usr/share/nginx/html`
- Proxies `/api/*` requests to backend service
- Single-page application routing support (fallback to `index.html`)
- File upload size limit: 50MB